



WHAT WILL STOP WORK SIX MONTHS FROM NOW?

The JiTpro Field Guide to Construction Procurement Control

How general contractors protect field execution, reduce preventable disruption, and retain more of the margin they earn

A PRACTICAL GUIDE FROM JITPRO

A decorative graphic in the bottom right corner consisting of two overlapping circles. The outer circle is a darker orange, and the inner circle is a lighter, brighter orange.

THE JITPRO THESIS

The governing idea

The construction schedule cannot survive if the products, materials, and services required to execute the work do not arrive complete, correct, approved, and ready when the field needs them.

And those things cannot arrive correctly and on time unless all of the upstream information, decisions, scope, commitments, approvals, buyout, submittals, fabrication, and logistics happen in the proper sequence and at the proper time.

That is the central problem JiTpro exists to solve.

This guide explains how a general contractor can take early control of that chain, even when many of the decisions affecting it belong to other people.

It is not a promise that a project will never change. Construction contains uncertainty. Owners revise requirements. Design evolves. Unforeseen conditions emerge. Authorities affect the work. Markets and manufacturing conditions change.

The objective is more practical:

**Prevent preventable disruption. Manage change as it occurs.
Preserve the cause-and-effect record.**

Contents

- 1 The schedule creates demand
- 2 Procurement is bigger than purchasing
- 3 Late procurement often begins as missing information
- 4 The general contractor inherits the project as it actually exists
- 5 A six-month field problem is created today
- 6 The Jiipro construction procurement workflow
- 7 Use Just-in-Time thinking to direct attention
- 8 Manage plan, commitment, actual, and forecast
- 9 Prevent preventable disruption. Manage change as it occurs. Preserve the cause-and-effect record.
- 10 From item health to company health
- 11 Why this is difficult to do consistently
- 12 Procurement control self-assessment
- 13 Start with one project

1

The schedule creates demand

A construction schedule is more than a series of activities and dates. It is a statement of future demand.

When the schedule says framing begins, the field will need lumber, engineered wood, hardware, labor, equipment, approved details, and suitable site conditions. When it says tile installation begins, the field will need selected and approved material, verified quantities, coordinated substrates, completed waterproofing, delivered tile, setting materials, and an installer ready to work.

Every scheduled activity creates demand for some combination of:

- Products
- Materials
- Services
- Labor and equipment
- Design and engineering information
- Owner decisions and selections
- Permits and agency approvals
- Scope definition and trade coordination
- Submittals, reviews, revisions, and approvals
- Fabrication, transportation, staging, and installation readiness

If those requirements are not satisfied when the field reaches the activity, the schedule is no longer executable as planned.

That leads to the first control principle:

The construction schedule creates demand. The procurement schedule proves how that demand will be met.

An activity can appear perfectly reasonable in the construction schedule while the chain required to support it is already broken. A finish activity may be scheduled for May, but the owner selection required to hold that date may be due in November. A structural-steel installation may be months away, but the unresolved engineering information preventing shop drawings may require action this week.

The field usually discovers a procurement failure at the end of the chain. Effective procurement control begins at the other end.

It asks:

What must happen, by whom, and by when, for the field to execute this work as scheduled?

2

Procurement is bigger than purchasing

Procurement is often treated as purchasing. That definition starts too late and excludes most of the work required to make a purchase useful to the field.

For a general contractor, procurement means bringing every required product, material, and service to the project when scheduled and needed, complete, correct, approved, and ready for use.

Construction procurement is the process of planning, identifying, defining, sourcing, contracting, coordinating, approving, fabricating, delivering, and making ready every product, material, service, and supporting decision required to execute the work when the field needs it.

Contract and buyout are only part of the procurement chain.

A complete chain may include:

- Identifying the item and its relationship to field work
- Confirming the scope across drawings, specifications, schedules, and consultant documents
- Resolving design gaps and system interfaces
- Completing owner selections and decisions
- Obtaining structural, specialty, or delegated engineering
- Establishing trade responsibility
- Sourcing and evaluating subcontractors and suppliers
- Completing buyout and scope alignment
- Preparing product data, samples, mockups, and shop drawings
- Coordinating reviews among the architect, engineers, consultants, owner, and contractor
- Completing revisions and resubmittals
- Obtaining permits and authority approvals
- Receiving final approval and authorizing release
- Fabricating or manufacturing the item
- Performing quality control and inspections
- Coordinating freight, delivery, unloading, protection, storage, and staging
- Verifying field dimensions and installation readiness

A purchase order does not prove that this chain is viable. Neither does a delivery date entered in a log.

An ordinary procurement log often records the expected outcome. Procurement control manages the work that must produce that outcome.

The controlling date: Required on Site

Every significant procurement item should begin with one governing downstream date: the **Required on Site Date, or RoSD**.

The RoSD is the date the product, material, or equipment must be physically available on the project to support the construction schedule. Every upstream procurement activity and commitment is derived backward from that date using the correct sequence and realistic durations.

If the item must arrive before installation to allow receiving, inspection, damage resolution, acclimation, testing, preassembly, staging, protection, or preparation, that time should be established in the construction schedule and reflected in the RoSD. The procurement chain should not depend on a vague distinction between when an item is "on site" and when it is "in the field."

Two upstream events must also remain distinct:

Subcontract or purchase-order buyout complete The commercial agreement is executed, and the responsible subcontractor, supplier, or manufacturer is authorized to perform the contracted work.

Released for fabrication or order The coordinated and approved product is formally authorized for fabrication or ordering. The required release date is the latest date this can occur without placing the RoSD at risk.

Buyout does not necessarily authorize fabrication. A subcontract may be executed while selections, engineering, coordination, submittals, or approvals remain incomplete.

The time between buyout, release, and the RoSD must reflect the actual product and project conditions. It may include phased releases, production constraints, freight, inspections, holidays, shutdowns, and non-working days.

"Needed in June," without an understanding of every step required to deliver the item in June, is not a procurement plan.

3

Late procurement often begins as missing information

The visible problem may be a late product. The first failure may have been missing information months earlier.

A subcontractor cannot prepare an accurate submittal for undefined work. An architect cannot approve a system that has not been coordinated. A manufacturer cannot fabricate from an unapproved submittal. The field cannot install what has not been fabricated and delivered.

The chain may look like this:

Missing selection leads to **incomplete scope** which prevents **buyout** which delays **submittal preparation** which delays **review and approval** which delays **release** which delays **fabrication and delivery** which stops **field execution**.

This is why information belongs inside the procurement process.

For every significant item, the project should test whether the information needed to procure it actually exists:

- Where is the item shown?
- Where is it specified?
- Are the drawings and specifications consistent?
- Is the quantity or extent reasonably defined?
- Is responsibility assigned to the correct party?
- Are the performance criteria complete?
- Has the final product, material, finish, or system been selected?
- Are dimensions, details, interfaces, and tolerances coordinated?
- Are consultant and specialty-engineering requirements available?
- Does the item depend on field verification or preceding work?
- Are allowances, alternates, substitutions, or owner-furnished conditions resolved?
- Are permitting or authority requirements known?

When the answer is no, the project does not merely have a document problem. It has a future procurement and field-execution problem.

Scope gaps become procurement gaps

An undefined interface can prevent buyout. An unclear responsibility can delay shop drawings. A missing finish selection can prevent release. A conflict between architectural and structural documents can stop fabrication.

A schedule can display precise dates and still have no credible path to achieve them.

Every material scope or information gap should produce a documented record containing:

- The missing requirement or question
- The documents and conditions reviewed
- The organization responsible for the decision or information
- The named person expected to act
- The date the answer is required
- The next procurement activity that cannot proceed without it
- The field activity ultimately placed at risk

A procurement schedule is only as reliable as the scope and information beneath it.

4

The general contractor inherits the project as it actually exists

At contract award, the general contractor does not inherit an ideal project. It inherits the project at its actual state of development.

The drawings may be incomplete. Details may conflict. Specifications may identify a category without defining a final product. Consultants may still be coordinating. Owners may have major selections remaining. Engineering may be unfinished. Permit comments may still affect the work.

Common inherited conditions include:

- Missing or incomplete design information
- Unresolved owner selections
- Conflicts among drawings, specifications, schedules, and consultant documents
- Products that have not been evaluated for current lead time
- Incomplete structural or specialty engineering
- Scope shown but not clearly assigned
- Scope specified but not shown
- Missing performance criteria
- Open permit or authority requirements
- Work dependent on field measurement or preceding construction

Many final decisions belong to the owner, architect, engineer, designer, consultant, issuing agency, subcontractor, supplier, or manufacturer. The general contractor cannot make all of those decisions.

But the general contractor is accountable for communicating the dependencies that affect its ability to execute the work.

The GC may not control every decision, but the GC is responsible for identifying, communicating, and documenting the dependencies that affect field execution.

That responsibility is not about transferring blame. It is about creating the conditions for the team to act while useful options still exist.

For each dependency, the project needs a clear answer to six questions:

- 1 What is required?
- 2 Which organization or project role is responsible?

- 3 Which named person owns the commitment?
- 4 When is it required?
- 5 What work cannot proceed without it?
- 6 What consequence will follow if it is late?

The date should never appear arbitrary. A useful request explains the chain:

Final stone selection is required from the owner by October 12 so the supplier can confirm slab availability, complete layout, obtain approval, fabricate, and deliver before the January 22 installation start.

Now the recipient understands not only what is needed, but why the date matters.

5

The field problem discovered six months from now may already exist today

Imagine that the field reports on May 15:

"The windows arrived late, and they do not fit the framed openings."

The failure did not begin on May 15. By then, the project has both a schedule problem and a correctness problem.

Worked example: custom steel window package

The required path

The correct process works backward from the RoSD and preserves every control needed to deliver the right windows at the right time.

Required activity	Required date
Required on site	May 15
Shipping, delivery, unloading, and inspection	May 8
Fabrication complete	May 1
Fabrication begins, 12 weeks	February 7
Released for fabrication	February 2
Final review complete	January 29
Revisions complete	January 20
Initial submittal delivered	January 8
Shop drawing preparation begins	December 16
Field verification and multidisciplinary coordination complete	December 15
Subcontractor buyout complete	December 12
Final opening details complete	December 5

Required activity	Required date
Owner finish selection complete	November 25
Design coordination resolved	November 18

The May problem already existed in November as unresolved information.

How the process went wrong

Now consider what happens when the project continues moving without clear direction.

Design coordination is not resolved on November 18. The owner finish selection is also late. The subcontract is bought with qualifications because the team does not want to lose more time. Pressure begins to grow.

Shop drawings start from incomplete information. Field verification and multidisciplinary coordination are deferred because the project is already behind. The initial submittal contains assumptions. Review comments expose conflicts that should have been resolved before preparation began.

The team now has less time and fewer options. Instead of restoring the missing controls, it compresses the review period, combines coordination with revision, and pushes for approval. The submittal is released for fabrication with opening dimensions that were never fully reconciled with the framed conditions.

Fabrication begins late. Shipping is expedited. The windows arrive after the RoSD, and several units do not fit.

The unresolved information did not disappear as the project advanced. It was carried downstream while the time and opportunity to correct it decreased.

The consequences now compound:

- Openings cannot be completed or dried in as planned
- Temporary protection is required
- Interior work is exposed, delayed, or resequenced
- The manufacturer must investigate, modify, or remake units
- Installation crews must be remobilized
- Expedited fabrication and premium freight may be required
- Project management and superintendent time increases
- Responsibility becomes disputed
- The project completion date may be affected

The pattern is predictable:

Time to act becomes **reduced options** which becomes **schedule compression** which encourages **skipped controls and workarounds** which becomes **field disruption** which produces **expensive recovery**.

Schedule pressure does not resolve missing information. It encourages the project to carry unresolved conditions forward while removing the checks that might have caught them.

If design coordination is unresolved on November 18, the project has not necessarily suffered a delay yet. It has discovered a threat to the chain while options may still exist.

If the unresolved condition is identified in November, the team may still be able to:

- Clarify the minimum information required to proceed
- Separate design issues that do not affect release
- Phase shop drawings or fabrication
- Protect a production slot
- Evaluate an alternate source or system
- Accelerate a review
- Change field sequence
- Obtain a documented decision about time, cost, or scope

If the owner selection arrives two weeks late, the required-on-site date does not automatically move two weeks. The project must determine whether float remains, whether work can be compressed, whether the manufacturer can preserve production capacity, whether mitigation adds cost, and what downstream dates are now forecast.

If the late selection resulted from an owner-directed change, the change may be legitimate. But if the event is not connected to the procurement chain when it occurs, the general contractor may later struggle to explain its schedule and cost effect.

The purpose of early control is not to declare failure sooner. It is to discover conditions early enough that the team can still make calm, informed, lower-cost decisions without skipping the coordination and verification required to get the work right.

Jiopro exists to find the November problem before it becomes the May field problem.

6

The JiTpro construction procurement workflow

The JiTpro workflow connects field demand to upstream action. Each step provides information required by the next.

Step 1: Establish field demand

Start with field execution, not the procurement log.

Identify the scheduled work, its location and sequence, and the products, materials, services, approvals, and information required to perform it.

Ask:

- What work is planned?
- Where and in what sequence will it occur?
- What must be physically available?
- What must be complete before installation can begin?
- What receiving, inspection, staging, testing, conditioning, or preassembly is required?
- Are there storage, access, crane, hoist, delivery, or protection constraints?

The result is a credible RoSD tied to actual work. If receiving, inspection, staging, testing, conditioning, preassembly, or protection must occur before installation, that work belongs in the construction schedule and must be reflected in the RoSD.

Step 2: Build the complete procurement inventory

The project cannot control what it has not identified.

Build an inventory of every meaningful product, material, service, and decision-driven requirement. Do not limit the inventory to traditional long-lead items. An ordinary item can become critical when its scope is incomplete, availability changes, approvals expand, or field measurements are required.

Define each item at the level required for control. "Finishes" is too broad. "Tile" may also be too broad if separate rooms have different selections, review paths, lead times, suppliers, or installation dates.

Separate items when they have different:

- Required on Site Dates
- Responsible parties
- Design or selection dependencies
- Submittal and approval paths

- Fabrication durations
- Suppliers or manufacturers
- Areas, phases, or releases
- Risk profiles

On a complex project, the complete inventory may contain hundreds of items and many more upstream dependencies. That is not unnecessary detail. It is the workload already embedded in the project becoming visible.

Step 3: Prove the scope and information

Test the documents and current project conditions for each significant item.

Confirm that the item is sufficiently defined to be priced, assigned, coordinated, submitted, approved, fabricated, delivered, and installed. Record every condition that prevents the chain from progressing.

Do not allow precise dates to create false confidence over unresolved scope.

Step 4: Map the procurement chain

Identify the actual work between today's project condition and field execution.

A typical chain may include:

Selections, decisions, design, and engineering to scope alignment and buyout to submittal coordination and field verification to submittal preparation to initial multidisciplinary review to revision, coordination, and resubmittal to final approval to release for fabrication or order to fabrication and quality control to shipping and delivery to the Required on Site Date.

The chain must reflect the real item. A permit, custom window package, switchgear assembly, stone package, and concrete mix design do not follow identical paths.

Step 5: Work backward from the Required on Site Date

Begin with the RoSD and calculate backward through the complete chain. Do not start with a promised delivery date, a standard lead time, or a date copied from a procurement log.

A representative backward-planned chain is:

- 1 Required on Site Date**
- 2 Shipping, transportation, and delivery**
- 3 Fabrication or order lead time**
- 4 Release for fabrication or order**
- 5 Final approval**
- 6 Review, coordination, and revision cycles**
- 7 Initial submittal**
- 8 Submittal preparation**
- 9 Submittal coordination and field verification**
- 10 Subcontract or purchase-order buyout**
- 11 Design, engineering, and product definition complete**

12 Owner selections and decisions complete

This is a representative sequence, not a universal template. A permit, custom window package, switchgear assembly, stone package, and concrete mix design may require different activities, parallel paths, agency reviews, mockups, field measurements, or phased releases. Selections may be required before design can be completed. Delegated engineering may begin after buyout. Trade coordination may continue during submittal preparation.

The governing requirement is simple:

Every procurement item must be mapped according to the work actually required to deliver that item correctly by its RoSD.

Confirm every step and duration

For each activity, ask what must actually be complete before the next can begin:

- Does the quoted lead time begin at purchase order, deposit, approved submittal, or formal fabrication release?
- Does fabrication duration include manufacturer engineering and quality control?
- Is shipping or transportation included, and what delivery constraints apply?
- Is the quote current and based on present production capacity?
- Does the manufacturer require every selection and dimension before starting?
- Are holidays, shutdowns, and non-working days accounted for?
- Can the package be approved or released in phases?
- Does submittal preparation depend on field measurements, coordination drawings, or preceding work?
- Which disciplines and trades must participate in coordination and review?

Plan review and revision cycles deliberately

Review time must include more than an architect's contractual review period. It may require owner input, multidisciplinary design review, trade coordination, delegated engineering, samples, mockups, revisions, resubmittals, and final approval.

For an ordinary but meaningful package, the plan should generally allow for:

- 1 Initial submittal
- 2 Initial multidisciplinary review
- 3 Revision and coordination
- 4 Resubmittal
- 5 Final review and approval

The schedule should include at least one realistic review-and-revision cycle unless the package and project conditions justify otherwise. Complex, multidisciplinary, owner-sensitive, or incompletely designed packages may require additional planned cycles.

The purpose is not to normalize incomplete submittals or repeated rejection. The objective remains a complete, coordinated initial submittal. The schedule allowance recognizes the review and coordination the actual package is reasonably expected to require.

The number of cycles should be established deliberately based on package complexity, design completeness, reviewing disciplines, owner involvement, consultant involvement, delegated engineering, mockups, permit requirements, and experience with the responsible trade partner. It should not be inherited from a generic template.

After calculating backward, schedule the chain forward from the current project condition to test whether it remains achievable. Backward planning establishes when each upstream event is required. Forward testing reveals whether the work completed, commitments made, and time remaining can still satisfy the RoSD.

Step 6: Convert dependencies into commitments

A dependency describes what must happen. A commitment states who will make it happen and by when.

Every critical commitment should contain:

Field	Required answer
Requirement	What must be provided, decided, completed, or approved?
Responsible party	Which organization or project role owns the work?
Commitment owner	Which named person is expected to act?
Required date	When is action needed to protect downstream work?
Downstream dependency	What cannot proceed without it?
Consequence	What is placed at risk if the date is missed?
Status and history	What was promised, what changed, and what actually occurred?

Avoid assigning critical commitments to vague groups such as "design team" or "owner." Name the responsible organization and the person expected to act.

Step 7: Track plan, commitment, actual, and forecast

Do not erase the plan each time circumstances change.

For every meaningful activity, preserve:

- Baseline or planned date
- Committed date
- Actual start and finish
- Current forecast

- Variance and reason
- Responsible event or decision
- Remaining float or schedule protection
- Downstream effect
- Approved schedule adjustment, when applicable

This distinction matters. If the forecast simply replaces the original date, the project loses the evidence required to understand performance and causality.

Step 8: Manage by exception

The objective is not to review hundreds of line items with equal intensity. It is to direct attention to the few actions that matter now.

Act now A required commitment is due or missed, float is exhausted, or immediate intervention is needed.

Watch closely The chain remains achievable, but a changing duration, weak handoff, pending decision, or missed interim target is consuming protection.

On plan The chain is progressing within the current plan and does not require escalation.

Priority should be derived from downstream field need, not from the newest email, the loudest voice, or the item that happens to be discussed first.

Step 9: Document change and causality

When an event changes the plan, connect it to the affected procurement chain while the facts are current.

Record:

- What changed
- When it became known
- Who initiated, controlled, or was responsible for the event
- Which commitment or activity was affected
- The original required date
- The mitigation evaluated or attempted
- The revised forecast
- The downstream procurement and field effect
- The notice, schedule update, or contract documentation issued

This creates a contemporaneous causal record instead of forcing the team to reconstruct the story at the end of the project.

7

Use Just-in-Time thinking to direct attention

JiTpro applies a practical Just-in-Time principle to construction information and procurement:

The right work should happen at the right time to support downstream demand.

Too late creates disruption. But treating every issue as urgent creates another kind of waste.

When every open decision receives an ASAP label:

- The architect cannot distinguish true schedule priority
- The owner is pressured to decide without adequate preparation
- Consultants respond to noise instead of downstream need
- Subcontractors begin work from incomplete inputs
- Project managers repeatedly chase information without a clear sequence
- Superintendents compensate through resequencing and workarounds

The objective is not to accelerate everything. It is to establish when each decision, approval, buyout, submittal, release, and delivery is actually required, then focus the team on the work that should happen now.

This reduces cognitive overload.

A project manager may be carrying hundreds of open items. The superintendent needs immediate field decisions. The architect has dozens of questions. The owner has multiple selections. Subcontractors need clarification. Suppliers are protecting production capacity.

No person can reliably hold the entire project in memory and continuously calculate which upstream condition threatens which future activity.

The useful question is not merely:

What remains open?

It is:

Which few things require attention today because failing to act will create a field problem months from now?

JiTpro is not intended to make the team work harder. It is intended to help the team work on the right things at the right time.

8

Manage plan, commitment, actual, and forecast

A procurement chain is not controlled by a single status label.

Each critical activity has at least four different truths:

Plan What the project originally intended or required.

Commitment What a named person or organization said it would do.

Actual What occurred and when.

Forecast What the project now expects based on current information.

Those truths should not be collapsed into one editable date.

Consider a simplified structural-steel record:

Record	Date or result
Steel required on site	June 15
Fabrication duration	10 weeks
Required fabrication release	April 6
Required approved submittal	March 30
Required design information	February 12
Architect commitment	February 12
Actual information received	March 5
Variance	21 calendar days
Current result	Release and fabrication forecast shifted

The project can now evaluate mitigation, time, cost, responsibility, and required notice while the condition is active.

Meeting discipline

Procurement meetings should not become line-by-line readings of a massive log.

Organize discussion around:

- Commitments due before the next meeting

- Missed commitments and their downstream consequences
- New risks and changed lead times
- Decisions requiring escalation
- Items approaching loss of float
- Mitigation options requiring approval
- Schedule or contract documentation that must be issued

Record decisions, owners, and dates during the meeting. Publish the record promptly. Carry unresolved commitments forward without erasing their original dates or history.

9

Prevent preventable disruption. Manage change as it occurs. Preserve the cause-and-effect record.

Construction will always contain legitimate uncertainty.

Schedule and procurement conditions may change because of:

- Owner-directed changes or added scope
- Design revisions
- Unforeseen conditions
- Authority or permit action
- Consultant-driven changes
- Material availability events outside the parties' reasonable control
- Other contractually recognizable impacts

A changing schedule is not necessarily a failing schedule.

An unexplained schedule is.

When a legitimate event occurs, the project should identify it, connect it to the affected procurement chain, evaluate mitigation, forecast the effect, document the time and cost consequences, and incorporate approved adjustments into the project record.

A chain of custody for change

- 1 What changed?
- 2 When was the event first known?
- 3 Who initiated or controlled it?
- 4 Which commitment or procurement activity did it affect?
- 5 What was the original required date?
- 6 What mitigation was evaluated or attempted?
- 7 What is the current forecast?
- 8 Which downstream procurement and field activities changed?
- 9 What notice, schedule update, or contract documentation was issued?

Documentation runs through the entire process. The original requirement, planned sequence, commitments, actual performance, mitigation, changes, and downstream effects should all be preserved. Within that continuous record, the project has three different responsibilities:

Prevent preventable disruption. Expose missing information, incomplete scope, late commitments, changing lead times, and weak handoffs while lower-cost options remain available.

Manage change as it occurs. Help the team understand the condition, evaluate mitigation, make decisions, and forecast downstream effects while the event is active.

Preserve the cause-and-effect record. Maintain the contemporaneous history required to explain preventable misses, legitimate changes, mitigation efforts, and their time and cost consequences.

All three protect the general contractor's ability to execute the work and retain the margin it earns.

10

From item health to company health

Procurement control begins at the item level, but its value compounds when the same operating method is applied across a project and across the company.

Item health

Item health asks whether one procurement chain is viable.

- Is the RoSD defined and tied to the construction schedule?
- Is the scope sufficiently complete?
- Is the backward-planned sequence achievable?
- Are critical commitments assigned and progressing?
- Is current performance consuming float?
- Is an intervention required now?

Project health

Project health asks whether the full portfolio of procurement chains supporting one project is under control.

- How many items require action now?
- Which future field activities are exposed?
- Where are unresolved scope and information concentrated?
- Which commitments are repeatedly missed?
- Are risks being identified early or discovered in the field?
- Is the project becoming more controlled or more reactive?

Company health

Company health asks whether patterns are repeating across projects.

- Where do scope gaps repeatedly originate?
- Which types of owner, design, consultant, or internal commitments are consistently late?
- Which procurement categories repeatedly create disruption or recovery cost?
- Where is project-management attention repeatedly consumed?
- Which teams identify risk early, and what practices can be repeated?
- Are active projects becoming healthier or more reactive over time?
- Where are company systems creating preventable waste?

This progression turns individual project records into operational knowledge.

Item health reveals the next intervention. **Project health** reveals where leadership attention is needed. **Company health** reveals where the organization can improve how it plans and delivers work.

11

Why this is difficult to do consistently

Most general contractors already have a project schedule, submittal log, procurement log, RFI log, meeting minutes, email, document-management system, and capable project staff.

The problem is not the complete absence of information.

The problem is that the information is fragmented across systems, documents, organizations, and people. Each source describes part of the project, but none necessarily connects today's unresolved condition to the downstream field activity it can affect months later.

Consistent procurement control requires the project to:

- Inventory hundreds of products, materials, services, and supporting decisions
- Prove scope across drawings, specifications, schedules, and consultant documents
- Build item-specific procurement chains
- Validate current lead times, production constraints, and review paths
- Establish named commitments across multiple organizations
- Monitor actual performance and changing forecasts
- Recalculate downstream effects as conditions change
- Surface a small number of priority actions without creating more noise
- Preserve the causal history of change
- Give project and company leadership useful visibility

Most teams perform pieces of this work. Far fewer have one disciplined system for executing all of it continuously.

JiTpro integrates these fragments around downstream field demand.

It creates:

- **Visibility:** a complete inventory tied to field execution
- **Scope confidence:** evidence that the work is sufficiently defined to procure
- **Sequence:** a credible path from present condition to field readiness
- **Accountability:** named commitments stating what is needed, from whom, by when, and why
- **Priority:** a focused view of the actions that matter now
- **Forecast:** a current understanding of where each chain is heading
- **Documentation:** a causal record connecting requirements, events, decisions, variance, and downstream effects
- **Health:** item-level, project-level, and company-level understanding of procurement control

The result is not another administrative list. It is an operating method for finding future problems early enough to do something useful about them.

12

Procurement control self-assessment

Answer **Yes**, **Partly**, or **No** for one current project.

Score each answer:

- **Yes = 2 points**
- **Partly = 1 point**
- **No = 0 points**

Field demand and inventory

- 1 Does every significant product, material, and service have a Required on Site Date tied to the construction schedule?
- 2 Does the procurement inventory include supporting design, decisions, engineering, approvals, and services?
- 3 Are items separated at the level required to control different dates, parties, approval paths, and releases?

Scope and information

- 1 Has the team tested whether each significant item's scope is complete, coordinated, and assigned?
- 2 Are unresolved design requirements and owner selections tracked against downstream need dates?
- 3 Does each material scope gap identify the field activity ultimately affected?

Sequence and schedule

- 1 Are procurement dates derived backward from the RoSD through every activity required to deliver the item correctly?
- 2 Are current fabrication, review, delivery, and readiness durations documented and periodically reconfirmed?
- 3 Are shipping, fabrication, approval, review and revision cycles, submittal preparation, coordination, field verification, buyout, design, selections, non-working days, and other item-specific conditions included where applicable?

Commitments and accountability

- 1 Does every critical dependency have a named commitment owner and required date?
- 2 Does each commitment explain what downstream work depends on it and what is at risk?
- 3 Are missed commitments carried forward without losing their original date and history?

Risk, forecast, and change

- 1 Can the team see which few items require action now to protect work months from now?
- 2 Are risks identified before activities become late?
- 3 Are baseline, commitment, actual, and forecast dates preserved separately?
- 4 Are missed commitments connected to downstream procurement and field effects?
- 5 Are mitigation decisions and legitimate causes of schedule change documented as they occur?

Leadership visibility

- 1 Can project leadership understand procurement health without manually reading hundreds of line items?
- 2 Can the company identify recurring sources of scope gaps, late commitments, and recovery effort across projects?
- 3 Is the team spending its attention on downstream priority rather than generalized urgency?

Interpret your score

32 to 40: Strong procurement control Your project has many elements of a disciplined operating method. Review every Partly and No answer for hidden breaks between systems, teams, or phases.

22 to 31: Material visibility and execution gaps Your team may have capable people and useful logs, but disconnected information or inconsistent accountability can still hide future field risk.

0 to 21: High dependence on reactive management The project may be relying heavily on personal memory, informal follow-up, generalized urgency, and downstream recovery. Begin with the field activities that carry the greatest schedule or operational consequence.

The score is a starting point, not a verdict. The value is in identifying where the chain breaks.

Five questions for this week's project meeting

- 1 Which field activities in the next six months depend on unresolved information today?
- 2 Which procurement chains lack a credible owner for a critical commitment?
- 3 Which lead times or review durations have not been validated recently?
- 4 Which planned dates have changed without a documented reason and downstream assessment?
- 5 Where are we spending attention on noise while schedule-critical work receives too little?

Start with one project

JiTpro helps the general contractor take early control of the decisions, information, products, materials, services, and commitments that support field execution.

We begin with the construction schedule and establish when each product, material, and service is required on site. Then we work backward from the RoSD through the actual procurement chain, expose the conditions that can prevent it from succeeding, establish documented accountability, track actual performance, and direct attention to the actions that matter now.

Construction will always involve uncertainty. JiTpro does not promise to eliminate it.

Our objective is to eliminate as much preventable chaos as possible, help the team manage legitimate change while it is happening, and preserve a clear causal record of what affected the work.

The goal is not to make your team work harder. It is to help them work on the right things at the right time.

Field guide summary

- 1 Start with the construction schedule and establish the RoSD.
- 2 Build the complete product, material, service, and decision inventory.
- 3 Prove the scope and information before trusting the dates.
- 4 Map the real procurement chain for each significant item.
- 5 Work backward from the RoSD and test the sequence forward.
- 6 Convert dependencies into named commitments with consequences.
- 7 Preserve plan, commitment, actual, and forecast.
- 8 Manage the few exceptions that require action now.
- 9 Document change and causality as events occur.
- 10 Use item health to understand project health and company health.
- 11 Prevent preventable disruption. Manage change as it occurs. Preserve the cause-and-effect record.

What will stop work six months from now?

The condition may already exist today.

Put JiTpro on one project and find it while the team still has time to act.

Start with one project.

Visit jit-pro.com to start a conversation.

JiTpro | Construction Procurement Control Copyright 2026 JiTpro. All rights reserved.